

The GFM Health Brief

Practical health facts & care notes from your family physician.

Blue Springs, Missouri

— Care that knows your name

At Garcia Family Medicine, you're a person, not a chart number. Led by Dr. Theresa "Tess" Garcia, MD, FAAFP, our practice is built around unhurried visits, real access to your physician, and care for the whole family — from childhood checkups to managing the conditions that come with every stage of life.

Good health rarely turns on one big decision. It's built from small, steady habits — and from catching problems early, before they catch you. That's the heart of family medicine, and the reason this little newsletter exists: a few facts worth knowing, and an open door whenever you need one.

"The best visit is the one that prevents the next emergency."

SPOTLIGHT • HEALTHY WEIGHT

Weight is health — and it's treatable.

Dr. Garcia is board-certified in Obesity Medicine (DABOM). Medical weight management goes far beyond willpower: it looks at metabolism, sleep, stress, medications, and nutrition together, with a plan made for *you*. If your weight has felt stuck, that's a medical conversation worth having.

BY THE NUMBERS

5 health facts worth knowing

- 1 150 minutes** of moderate activity a week — about 20–30 min a day — is the standard adult target, plus muscle-strengthening twice weekly.
- 2 High blood pressure has no symptoms.** Normal is generally under 120/80 mmHg. The only way to know yours is to check it.
- 3 7+ hours of sleep** a night is what most adults need. Short sleep is linked to heart disease, weight gain, and low mood.
- 4 Half your plate** fruits and vegetables is a simple rule that quietly improves fiber, blood sugar, and blood pressure.
- 5 Most colon cancer is preventable.** Routine screening for average-risk adults now starts at **age 45**. Ask if you're due.

— What we care for at GFM

One practice for the whole family — coordinated, personal, and close to home.



Primary & preventive care

Checkups, physicals, screenings, and vaccines for every age.



Chronic condition care

Diabetes, blood pressure, cholesterol, thyroid — managed over time.



Medical weight management

Board-certified obesity medicine with a plan built around you.



Acute & same-week visits

Coughs, infections, aches, and the “something’s off” days.



Women’s & men’s health

Wellness visits and age-appropriate screening, with privacy and respect.



Lifestyle & nutrition

Practical guidance on food, movement, sleep, and stress.

WORTH A VISIT WHEN...

- It’s been over a year since a checkup
- A new symptom won’t settle in 1–2 weeks
- Weight has felt stuck despite effort
- Your blood pressure runs high
- You’re managing a long-term condition
- You’re due for a screening (BP, cholesterol, colon)

A little tech, more face time. GFM uses **VoiceRx**, an in-house dictation tool, so your physician can spend the visit looking at *you* — not a keyboard — and still keep an accurate record.

Become a patient at GFM.

New patients welcome. Reach out to schedule or ask a question.

Call: [phone]

Online: [website]

[street address]

Blue Springs, Missouri

General wellness information — not medical advice. The facts in this newsletter are educational and reflect widely accepted public-health guidance for average-risk adults; individual recommendations vary. They are not a substitute for a visit with your physician, and nothing here creates a doctor-patient relationship. For personal guidance, talk with Garcia Family Medicine or your own clinician. In an emergency, call 911.